



Say: What?

The WhatSim was announced, recently - a cell phone Sim card dedicated to Whatsapp users. find out more: <http://dgit.in/thewhatsim>



Synthesize your pocket

Carry a synthesizer around with you in your pocket. Simple, easy-to-carry and cheap, these gadgets are great for composers working within a budget <http://dgit.in/pocksynth>

Bazaar

Audio-Technica ATH-MSR7

Reference grade audio packaged in a consumer-friendly avatar

High Resolution" audio seems to be quite the buzzword these days with the launch of digital audio players like the Sony Walkman ZX2 and Neil Young's PonoPlayer recently. The Audio-Technica ATH-MSR7 too goes to great lengths to tell you that it's meant for high resolution audio. For those who aren't familiar with the term, high resolution audio isn't a specific standard as such, rather only a term used to describe audio encoded at sampling rates greater than 44.1 kHz and with bit-depth greater than 16 bits. The MSR7 box has the "Hi-Res Audio" logo slapped on but we're not quite sure how it applies to a headphone. Either ways it doesn't matter because the MSR7 is a really beautiful looking and pristine sounding headphone. What Audio-Technica has done is essentially bring the sonic fidelity and aural chops of a production monitoring workhorse like say the M50 and fit it into a curvy and convenient package - something that an average joe aspiring audiophile will be comfortable using. How exactly has Audio-Technica done this? For starters this is a low impedance and high sensitivity headphone so you don't really need to break out your Amp to drive them. The MSR7 is portable too (it folds flat) and comes with three cable - one of which has in-line smartphone controls and a microphone.

Design, build and features

The headphone housing is supposed to be made from a mixture of aluminum and magnesium, layered to provide a lightweight but rigid structure. The headphone is indeed light and gives the impression of being well built. The headband adjusters feel sturdy and so does the sliding mechanism. The headphones inspire a fair amount of confidence which is good since they're portable they need to be built well enough to take a fair amount of jostling. The pads are made of soft memory foam. These don't get uncomfortable for long listening sessions, but being closed backed they do then to get warm.



Price
₹16,299

Now let's get down to business. What's the performance like?

Performance

The circumaural closed-back design, coupled with just the right amount of headband clamping pressure and memory foam pads make for very good isolation. The headphones are able to cut out ambient noise to quite an extent - a little more than say the HD280 pros or M50s if you're familiar with those. But the comfort is much more.

The sound signature is fairly neutral, at least more neutral than most headphones we've had. Although not in the same range, for the sake of reference we switched between the MSR7 and the Aurvana Live!2. While the Aurvana had it's bass accentuated, the MSR7 was accurate (true-to-source) and quite enjoyable. One of our test tracks, While My Guitar Gently Weeps (originally by The Beatles) feat. India.Arie & Yo-Yo Ma sounded especially nice. The Cello sounded beautiful and we ended up noticing nuances which we last remember hearing on the K240 MKII. Overall, they're precise, the bass is hard hitting, accurate and all frequency ranges are well represented.

Verdict

Though it is expensive, for the price, you'd be hard pressed to find headphones so accurate. Sure you could go for proper studio monitoring gear such as the Audio-Technica's own M50 or AKG's K612 PRO but you'd have to deal with all the seriousness those headphones come with. The MSR7 on the other hand is a mix of both worlds. You get great audio as well as the flexibility and design swag of a consumer focussed audio piece. If you want to take a definitive crack at what some would call "listening to audio the right way", the MSR7 is the perfect step in the right direction. Of course the sky's the limit from here on. But for starters you can't go wrong. The comfort, hardy build, portability, bundled cables all make it a worthwhile purchase.

Siddharth Parwatay



Performance.....	78
Features	75
Build	72
Value	72

Specifications

Driver: 45 mm; **Frequency Response:** 5 - 40,000 Hz; **Maximum Input Power:** 2,000 mW; **Sensitivity:** 100 dB/mW; **Impedance:** 35 ohms; **Weight:** 290 g; **Cable:** Detachable 1.2 m, 3.0 m, 1.2 m with mic

Contact

Origin Marketing Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 22-28835886
Email: reuben@origingames.in